



expression of Indian displeasure, at least by recalling the high commissioner at that time, was required. But it was not done. I continue to regard Sharm el-Sheikh as a disaster, and I hope we stand firm on not holding a dialogue till the issue of terrorism is addressed or else the focus is going to change. Pakistan has to be told that it will have to pay a price, not just a diplomatic price which it has paid but also a price otherwise, for what it is doing. Covert and overt actions need to be essential ingredients of our policy. Besides we should make our tolerance threshold clear. The fact is that Pakistan has problems in Afghanistan as well as Iran. These are things we need to work on. So if you ask me, a policy of selective engagement, particularly on terrorism, is called for. The composite dialogue should be put into cold storage for now. As far as contact with the civil society is concerned, I would say yes by all means. But do it unilaterally. You do not need a dialogue with Pakistan for that.

Satish Nambiar: Dialogue should continue if for nothing else but to create a sort of facade that we are not shying away from talks. I do not subscribe to the view that was

expressed by some people in a section of our strategic community that we should work towards the stability of Pakistan and the country should not be allowed to disintegrate. Frankly, I think if they want to go down the drain, good luck to them. We need to factor in the spillover effects of that and we should be prepared for it. I would like to clarify that I do not think the Americans, Europeans, Chinese and Saudis are going to allow Pakistan to disintegrate. They will individually and collectively do everything they can to help Pakistan and secure its future. There will be pressure on us to make concessions on Jammu and Kashmir from the US on the ground that Pakistan is doing everything to help them with their problems in Afghanistan. We should not allow that sort of thing.

Raj Chengappa: What more does India need to do on Kashmir? Also, how should we deal with Pakistan on the Hafiz Saeed issue?

Ved Marwah: Well from all accounts and reports, the situation in Kashmir is certainly not improving. Pakistan is hoping to destabilise the state and also taking active steps towards that direction. Now as far as dealing with

Pakistan is concerned, I think we should know where we have our leverage. We have our leverage in Balochistan and in some other parts of Pakistan. What we really need to convey to Pakistan is that if they commit a blatant anti-India act on the ground, a military act or otherwise, it will have to bear the repercussions. We have to respond when they blatantly cross or breach the ceasefire line or the ceasefire agreement. We must retaliate quietly but firmly and make the right diplomatic noises to cover it. I would say that diplomatically, I am not too unhappy with our dealings with Pakistan.

Our leverage with Pakistan is very limited or practically nil because Hafiz Saeed is a creation of the Pakistani establishment and they have not taken action against him. I think because that has happened because the image of the Indian Government is that of a soft state. P. Chidambaram has recovered it to some extent, but I think we need to get away from that because Pakistan may not be a homogeneous entity but they are united in treating India as a wishy-washy Hindu country.

Ajit Doval: Now when we talk about

THE BEST VERDICT on how India has dealt with Pakistan

What India has Done

VED MARWAH	SATISH NAMBIAR	BRAHMA CHELLANEY	AJIT KUMAR DOVAL	G. PARTHASARATHY	KAPIL KAK	KIRAN BEDI
I would say diplomatically we have not done too badly. But we need to be firm in our dealings.	On the diplomatic front, our approach has been calibrated. But engagement would have helped.	We did not even take symbolic steps like recalling our high commissioner post-26/11.	We have not done anything great. Pakistan is keeping quiet because of the Afghan issue.	India could do precious little. The circumstances surrounding 26/11 forced Pakistan to act.	Sharm el-Sheikh was one of the steps towards strategic leap of faith. But it was badly handled by us.	We have been inconsistent in our policy on Pakistan-sponsored terrorism.

What Needs to be Done

Work on India's leverages within Pakistan. Punish them for any act of terror.	India must not work for the stability of Pakistan. It should be allowed to disintegrate.	India's response has been dismal. The dialogue should not resume till they stop terrorism.	India needs to reiterate that it does not pose a threat. Have a consistent policy on Pakistan.	Do not resume dialogue with Pakistan. Have limited dialogue on terrorism.	Resume dialogue, look for out-of-the-box solutions to bridge the trust deficit.	We need to work in one voice and provide good governance so that we can take on Pakistan.
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